

FRANCE JEFFREY EPSTEIN

Epstein affair: Olivier Colom, the sexual predator's French 'friend' and networker

A former adviser at the Elysée under Nicolas Sarkozy, the ex-diplomat is at the heart of the Epstein case. His correspondence reveals a close relationship with the American sexual predator. He now claims to 'regret' his actions but insists he never 'participated in any private activities that were not strictly professional and lawful.'

By Jérôme Lefilliâtre, Corentin Lesueur and Ivanne Trippenbach
Published on February 15, 2026, at 5:00 am (Paris), updated on February 15, 2026, at 8:55 pm • 9 min read

Subscribers only



Menu

Subscribe



Jeffrey Epstein

How Epstein built his network

30 years of judicial negligence

French prosecutors investigate

Epstein's I

main French contacts: Olivier Colom. Despite this, the former deputy diplomatic adviser at the Elysée during Nicolas Sarkozy's five-year term as president (2007-2012) now finds himself at the center of the Epstein scandal for his prolific correspondence with the American sexual predator, between 2013 and 2019, as revealed in the trove of emails released by the US Department of Justice on January 30.

Today, the former diplomat, age 56, is a consultant to heads of state and business leaders through his company founded in 2016, OC Advisory, and is very active in Africa. According to a report by Africa Intelligence, the Frenchman, whom *Le Monde* interviewed at length, played a key role in organizing far-right leader Marine Le Pen's trip to Chad in 2025.

